

Dell going Z

Dell's new line of high-end Latitude Z notebooks to feature wireless charging

Where's the mouse?

Logitech's Lapdesk N315 has a nifty slide-out mouse pad

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If anything, our notebook test this year is testament to change – an evolution of sorts, we're the reason. Not us as in Digit, but every one of us users. Notebooks have walked the product life cycle in this country, from being playthings of the rich, to the drool-worthy devices of the new millennium to what they are today. Their design ethos has evolved – jack-of-all-trades no longer. Manufacturers no longer try to get cover every possible

usage pattern when they create a notebook. Different product lines have spawned catering to the needs of a specific faction of people. Corporate users, college goers, gamers, road warriors, entertainment junkies – there's a unique fix for everyone. And this is a good thing – for one you have a plethora of choices. Secondly, you get exactly what you want. A handful of vendors also offer custom configurations these days and this is, perhaps, the most significant telling point of the change of market focus from producer to consumer. Sure

people in the US have been enjoying their custom Dells for a long time, but for a choice deprived nation we're new to all this and we're gleefully happy to report an ever increasing user base hopping aboard this bandwagon.

This time we also awarded two Best Performers, which is unusual. However, we felt that the gaming notebooks deserved a Best Performer award of their own since the testing parameters and weights assigned were quite different from the other notebooks.

There were quite a few

brands that could not / did not participate in this test such as Samsung, LG, Fujitsu, Toshiba and Zenith for a variety of reasons. Despite this we got a good number of models – 31 in all – and as unique a bunch as we'd hope to get. From David to Goliath, from the proverbial tortoise to the hare, from Playboy Playmate-grade stuff to the mundane, there's truly something for everyone.

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Most people buying a laptop look to spend around Rs. 35,000 to Rs. 40,000. This is where the bulk of the shopping happens; volume games are always fun for manufacturers and competition is fierce. There is diversity to be had as well; some notebooks have basic builds and mediocre looks but better, more powerful components under the hood and vice versa. If you're looking for an affordable stunner Acer's Aspire 5810T might be down your alley – a superb looking notebook from Acer's new Travel Line series of notebooks with brushed aluminium livery in silver-gray. It's slim and the exteriors are exceptionally well built. It has a nice, large, matte-finished, 15.6-inch display that has nice brightness levels but poor viewing angles. Acer uses Intel's Laminar Wall Jet cooling technology that claims to keep your lap cool, not the notebook. This system uses parallel layers of jets of air, and is the same concept used to keep the outer walls of a jet engine cool. Since its processor

Notebooks have emerged from the shroud of generality and become more specialised towards specific purposes. In short they've evolved to become about as varied as the human beings using them. The adage 'something for everyone' is an understatement as manufacturers rush to provide tailor-made solutions

Laps, notes and books

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